Gilaki Language Global Encyclopedia

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INTRODUCTION

Gilaki is more than a language - it is a worldview. It carries the soul of the Gilan region: its rice fields, mountains, laughter, resistance, and lullabies. This encyclopedia is a tribute to a linguistic heritage that refuses to be forgotten.

GRAMMATICAL AND CULTURAL SNAPSHOT

- Linguistic Origin: A Northwestern Iranian language, descendant of Middle Persian, retaining unique phonetic and structural elements.
- Main Dialects:
  - Biehpish (Eastern Gilan)
  - Biehpas (Western Gilan)
  - Galeshi (Mountain region - highly archaic)
- Verb System: Multi-tense, mood-rich, expressive.
- Vocabulary Domains: Agriculture, nature, kinship, humor, ethics.

- Oral Literature: Proverbs, riddles, folktales (e.g., "Anesar", "Ghanbar", "Kooti-Kooti")

- Revitalization Efforts: Informal teaching, cultural festivals, media in Gilaki, and ongoing documentation.